

Daily Current Affairs Notes

Comprehensive Class Notes — 18 September 2026 | Compiled in English with Quick Revision & MCQs

1. Saudi Arabia–Yemen (Houthi) Conflict & Pakistan's Statement

Yemen lies just south of Saudi Arabia. Inside Yemen operates a rebel group called the **Houthis**, which is backed and armed (weapons, satellite imagery support) by **Iran**.

The Houthis carried out a **drone attack** on Saudi Arabia, targeting the area near **Mecca** (a highly revered Islamic holy site; other key Saudi cities include Medina and the capital **Riyadh**). This drone strike angered Muslim countries worldwide.

The Houthis also shot down a Saudi Arabian **F-15 fighter aircraft** (part of the 'Eagle' family, a 4th-generation aircraft — for comparison, India's Tejas (TEJAS) is a 4.5 generation aircraft). The Houthis used an indigenously developed missile to down the F-15.

Key geography: Yemen sits beside the **Bab-el-Mandeb** strait (connecting the Red Sea and the Gulf of Aden). The Houthis have announced intent to control this strait. To the north, the **Strait of Hormuz** is already under Iranian influence — so both key maritime routes are now at risk.

Marib — a town in Yemen near the city of Sana'a — holds Yemen's major oil reserves; this is also where the Saudi F-15 was shot down.

Pakistan reminded of a **Defence Pact** signed in early 2026 between **Saudi Arabia, Turkey, and Pakistan** (an Islamic countries' defence grouping), stating it would stand with Saudi Arabia and Turkey if needed against the Houthis/Iran.

Quick Revision: Houthis = Yemen rebel group backed by Iran; drone attack near Mecca; Saudi F-15 shot down; Bab-el-Mandeb & Strait of Hormuz = key strategic points; Marib = Yemen's oil town; 2026 Defence Pact = Saudi Arabia + Turkey + Pakistan.

2. Karnataka Police Exam — Historical Books (Sample Question)

A question asked to identify the **incorrect pair** of historical books/authors (based on the topic of historical books/chronicles covered earlier in class). The correct answer was option combination **C & D** (i.e., pairs involving 'Rajatarangini' style/'Indian Mirror' associations were the incorrect ones in the given options).

Quick Revision: Karnataka Police paper difficulty is comparable to state PSC-level GK; revise historical chronicles/authors thoroughly.

3. Global Gender Gap Index 2026

Released by the **World Economic Forum (WEF)**, whose annual meeting is held at **Davos, Switzerland**.

- Total countries covered: **145**
- India's Rank: **131** (unchanged from 2025 — India was also 131st last year)
- Pakistan: among the **bottom 3** countries
- Rank 1: **Iceland**
- Rank 2: **Finland** (Finland is also No.1 in the World Happiness Index)
- Rank 5: **Namibia** — first time an **African country** has entered the Top 5 (Namibia is in Africa; India's President recently visited Namibia)
- Last-ranked country: **Chad** (Africa)
- India's Score: **64.5%**
- Index parameters: Education, Health Survival, Political Empowerment, Economic Opportunity

Quick Revision: WEF releases Gender Gap Index at Davos; India Rank 131/145 (same as 2025); Iceland #1, Finland #2, Namibia #5 (first African Top-5 entry), Chad last; India score 64.5%.

4. NITI Aayog — Electric Vehicle (EV) Usage Data

NITI Aayog released data on EV adoption across Indian States/UTs. Current NITI Aayog leadership: **CEO — Anurag; Vice-Chairperson — Ashok** (both newly appointed).

- Highest EV usage (Overall / among Union Territories): **Delhi** (Rank 1)
- Rank 2 (Overall): **Maharashtra**
- If the question specifies 'State': answer is **Maharashtra** (since Delhi is a UT)

Quick Revision: NITI Aayog EV data: Delhi = top overall/UT; Maharashtra = top State; CEO-Anurag, Vice Chair-Ashok.

5. Gupta Period — Sanskrit Grammar (Sample Question)

Statement 1: The Gupta period is called the 'Golden Age' with respect to Sanskrit grammar — **Correct**.

Statement 2: Development of Sanskrit grammar was based on the compilations of **Panini, Patanjali, Amarasimha, and Chandragomin** — **Correct**.

Answer: Both statements are correct.

6. US Space-Based Weapons / Outer Space Treaty Violation

The **USA** announced it has developed and deployed weapons in Earth's orbit, called **'Orbit Weapons'**. The announcement was made by a US Secretary-level official.

Background: The **International Space Station (ISS)** was built in **1998** for research purposes. Countries like the USA and France have started building their own 'Space Armies' to protect satellites in Low Earth Orbit from interference.

This move violates the **Outer Space Treaty (1967)**, which prohibits placing weapons of any kind in space. The US has also already withdrawn from **UNESCO** and **WHO**, and has signalled a possible future exit from the **UN** as well.

Quick Revision: Outer Space Treaty = 1967 (bans weapons in space); ISS built 1998; US 'Orbit Weapons' violate this treaty; US already exited UNESCO & WHO.

7. Sports Terminology (Sample MCQ)

Given pairs: Deuce – Tennis (Correct); Penalty Stroke – Football (Incorrect, actually Hockey); Penalty Kick – Football (Correct, not Hockey); Free Hit – Cricket (Correct).

Answer: A & D (Deuce–Tennis and Free Hit–Cricket are the correctly matched pairs).

8. Net Zero Portal & NAPCC Dashboard

Two digital platforms launched by the **Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change**, launched by the **Minister of State — Kirti Vardhan Singh** (not the Cabinet Minister Bhupender Yadav, since the question specifies 'State Minister').

- Net Zero Portal:** Citizens/entities can declare their pledge and timeline to convert to Electric Vehicles (EVs) and become carbon-neutral (India's national target: carbon neutral by **2070**).
- NAPCC Dashboard:** Full form — **National Action Plan on Climate Change Dashboard**. Resolves citizen queries, e.g., EV purchase subsidies.

Context: **World Ozone Day** was celebrated on **16 September**. Usually focused on the **Montreal Protocol**, this year's focus was the **Kigali Protocol**, which targets **HFCs (Hydrofluorocarbons)** to protect the ozone layer. (Chronology: Vienna Convention → Montreal Protocol → Kigali Protocol amendment).

Quick Revision: Net Zero Portal + NAPCC Dashboard launched by MoEFCC (Minister of State Kirti Vardhan Singh); World Ozone Day = 16 Sept, this year's focus = Kigali Protocol (HFCs); India's Carbon Neutral target = 2070.

9. Poshan Abhiyaan (Sample Question)

Under the Ministry of Women & Child Development. September is observed as **Poshan Maah** (Poshan Week: 1–7 September). **Main objective:** focus on brain development in children during the **first 3 years** of life (not 6 or 7 years).

10. NAMASTE Scheme

A scheme launched for **manual scavengers** (sanitation workers who clean sewers/tanks). **Full form:** Option relating to **'Sanitation'** is correct (not Science/Sustainable) — **Answer: Option 3**.

Quick Revision: NAMASTE Scheme = for manual scavengers; full form includes 'National Action for Mechanised Sanitation Ecosystem' type wording built around Sanitation.

11. Hyderabad Liberation Day

Celebrated on **17 September** every year. Hyderabad is presently the capital of **Telangana**, located on the banks of the **Musi River**; also home to the famous **Charminar** and world-famous Hyderabad biryani.

- Telangana formed on: **2 June 2014**
- Hyderabad served as the **common capital** of Telangana and Andhra Pradesh from 2014 to 2024
- Andhra Pradesh — first linguistic state formed in **1953**; re-designated as a state under the **States Reorganisation Act, 1956**

- At Independence, Hyderabad was the largest **Princely State**, ruled by the **Nizam — Mir Osman Ali Khan**, the **7th Nizam**
- The **Razakars** (a militia group) opposed Hyderabad's integration with India
- India launched **Operation Polo** to integrate Hyderabad: conducted from **13 September 1948 to 17 September 1948**
- Operation Polo was led by **Gen. J.N. Chaudhuri**
- The **Standstill Agreement** between Hyderabad and India was signed on **29 November 1947**
- Hyderabad was merged into Andhra Pradesh under the States Reorganisation Act, **1956**

Quick Revision: Hyderabad Liberation Day = 17 September; Operation Polo = 13–17 Sept 1948, led by J.N. Chaudhuri; Nizam = Mir Osman Ali Khan (7th Nizam); Standstill Agreement = 29 Nov 1947; Telangana formed = 2 June 2014.

12. Sports — Number of Players (Sample MCQ)

Correct player counts: Cricket = 11 (not 16); Hockey = 11 (not 14); Kho-Kho = 9 (Correct); Kabaddi = 7 (Correct). **Answer: A & D** (Kho-Kho and Kabaddi pairs are correct).

13. Swachhata Hi Seva Campaign 2026

Launched from **17 September 2026 to 17 October 2026** (a one-month campaign), coinciding with PM Modi's birthday.

Theme: 'Swachhata Mein Sehbhaag – Swachh Bharat, Viksit Bharat'. Led jointly by the **Ministry of Jal Shakti** and **Ministry of Housing & Urban Affairs**.

Five focus pillars:

- Waste to Wealth
- Working with Safai Mitras (sanitation workers)
- Sahyog (cooperation) in cleanliness
- Jan Bhagidari (public participation)
- Swachh Pathshala (cleanliness education/schools)

A special **'Ek Din, Ek Ghanta' (One Day, One Hour)** cleanliness drive is planned on **2 October** (Mahatma Gandhi's birth anniversary, also International Day of Non-Violence). Note: **Swachh Bharat Abhiyan** itself was originally launched on **2 October 2014**, dedicated to Mahatma Gandhi.

Quick Revision: Swachhata Hi Seva 2026 = 17 Sept–17 Oct 2026; 5 pillars; led by Ministry of Jal Shakti + Ministry of Housing; Swachh Bharat Abhiyan launched 2 Oct 2014.

14. Match-the-Following — Fisheries Institutes HQs (Sample Question)

Matching institutions (Central Institute of Fisheries, National Institute of Oceanography, ICAR, National Bureau of Fish Genetic Resources) with their headquarters/locations. **Answer: Option 2.**

15. Artemis Accords — Djibouti Joins

Djibouti has become the **72nd country** to join NASA's **Artemis Accords** (launched in **2020**), aimed at sending humans to the Moon in future missions.

- Djibouti is located in the **Horn of Africa** (along with Somalia, Eritrea, and Ethiopia — remembered via 'SEID')
- Djibouti = **8th African country** to join the Accords
- 71st country to join was **Turkey**
- India** joined the Artemis Accords in **2023**
- The **Moon Agreement** (a separate treaty on not littering/polluting the Moon) was signed in **1979**
- Artemis mission timeline: Artemis I (2022, uncrewed test flight) → Artemis II (2024) → Artemis III (targeted 2026)
- Do not confuse with **Axiom-4 Mission** (also NASA-related) — under which **Shubhanshu Shukla** was sent to the International Space Station (not to the Moon)

Quick Revision: Artemis Accords: launched 2020 by NASA; Djibouti = 72nd member & 8th African country; Turkey = 71st; India joined 2023; Moon Agreement = 1979; Axiom-4 (Shubhanshu Shukla) ≠ Artemis.

16. World Bank — New Chief Economist

Michael Kremer (Nobel Laureate in Economics) has been appointed as the new **Chief Economist of the World Bank Group**, effective **1 October**, replacing **Indermit Gill**.

- World Bank formed in **1944**; HQ in **Washington D.C.**; established via the **Bretton Woods Conference**
- Old/original name: **International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD)**
- World Bank President is traditionally from the USA — current President: **Ajay Banga** (Indian-American)

- Michael Kremer** won the **2019 Nobel Prize in Economics**, jointly with **Abhijit Banerjee** and his wife **Esther Duflo**
- Nobel Prize in Economics: instituted in **1968**, first awarded in **1969**
- First Indian to win the Economics Nobel: **Amartya Sen (1998)**; he was awarded the **Bharat Ratna** in **1999**

Quick Revision: World Bank Chief Economist = Michael Kremer (from 1 Oct, replaces Indermit Gill); World Bank formed 1944, HQ Washington D.C., old name IBRD; President = Ajay Banga; Economics Nobel first given 1969; first Indian winner = Amartya Sen (1998).

17. Women's Premier League (WPL) 2027 — 5th Edition

Dates announced: **14 January 2027 to 7 February 2027**. Hosted by the **BCCI** (T20 format), with **5 franchises** participating.

- 2026 Champion: **Royal Challengers Bengaluru (RCB)**
- 2025 Champion: **Mumbai Indians**
- 2024 Champion: **RCB**
- 2023 Champion: **Mumbai Indians**
- Delhi** has been the runner-up in every edition so far (2023–2026)
- IPL (men's) formed in **2007** by BCCI; first edition in **2008**, won by **Rajasthan Royals**

Quick Revision: WPL 2027 (5th edition) = 14 Jan–7 Feb 2027, 5 teams; RCB won 2026 & 2024, MI won 2025 & 2023; Delhi = perennial runner-up.

18. World Athletics Championship 2029 — Nairobi, Kenya

For the **first time**, an African nation will host the World Athletics Championship — **Nairobi, Kenya**, in **2029**. (Kenya also hosts the HQ of the **UN Environment Programme (UNEP)**.)

- World Athletics HQ: **Monaco**; body formed in **1983**
- The Championship is **biennial** (held every 2 years)
- 2025 edition: **Tokyo, Japan**
- 2027 edition: **Beijing, China**
- 2029 edition: **Nairobi, Kenya** (first in Africa)
- 2031 edition: **Mainz, Germany**

Quick Revision: World Athletics HQ = Monaco (1983); Championship is biennial; 2025-Tokyo, 2027-Beijing, 2029-Nairobi (1st in Africa), 2031-Mainz.

19. Abhishek Sharma — Fastest T20I Century by an Indian

During the India vs Afghanistan T20I series, **Abhishek Sharma** scored the fastest T20I century by an Indian, in just **30 balls**, at the **Arun Jaitley Stadium, Delhi**, breaking **Rohit Sharma's** earlier record.

- Rohit Sharma's previous record: century in **35 balls** vs **Sri Lanka** in **2017**
- Abhishek Sharma's innings included **10 sixes** and **9 boundaries** (fours)

Quick Revision: Abhishek Sharma: fastest T20I ton by an Indian (30 balls) vs Afghanistan at Arun Jaitley Stadium, Delhi; broke Rohit Sharma's 35-ball record (vs Sri Lanka, 2017).

Current Affairs — MCQ Practice Set

Q1. As per Pakistan's recent statement, it will stand with which two countries against the Houthis/Yemen conflict, based on a Defence Pact signed in early 2026?

- (A) Iran and Yemen
- (B) Saudi Arabia and Turkey
- (C) UAE and Qatar
- (D) Iran and Turkey

Answer: (B) Saudi Arabia and Turkey

Q2. The Houthi rebel group, responsible for the recent drone attack on Saudi Arabia, is primarily backed by which country?

- (A) Iraq
- (B) Iran
- (C) Syria
- (D) Qatar

Answer: (B) Iran

Q3. 'Marib', recently in the news for oil reserves and a downed Saudi F-15 aircraft, is located in which country?

- (A) Saudi Arabia
- (B) Oman
- (C) Yemen
- (D) UAE

Answer: (C) Yemen

Q4. As per the Global Gender Gap Index, India's rank among 145 countries is:

- (A) 108
- (B) 127
- (C) 131
- (D) 142

Answer: (C) 131

Q5. Which country topped the Global Gender Gap Index 2026, and which African nation entered the Top 5 for the first time?

- (A) Finland; Namibia
- (B) Iceland; Namibia
- (C) Iceland; Chad
- (D) Norway; Kenya

Answer: (B) Iceland (Rank 1); Namibia (Rank 5 — first African nation in Top 5)

Q6. The Global Gender Gap Index is released annually by:

- (A) United Nations
- (B) World Economic Forum
- (C) World Bank
- (D) UNDP

Answer: (B) World Economic Forum (meeting held at Davos, Switzerland)

Q7. As per NITI Aayog data, which State recorded the highest number of Electric Vehicles (EVs)?

- (A) Delhi
- (B) Maharashtra
- (C) Karnataka
- (D) Gujarat

Answer: (B) Maharashtra (Delhi tops the UT/overall category)

Q8. The Sanskrit grammar tradition during the Gupta period was based on the works of Panini, Patanjali, Amarasingha and:

- (A) Kalidasa
- (B) Chandragomin
- (C) Vishnu Sharma
- (D) Bhavabhuti

Answer: (B) Chandragomin

Q9. The recently announced US 'Orbit Weapons' in space violate which international treaty?

- (A) Antarctic Treaty, 1959
- (B) Outer Space Treaty, 1967
- (C) Moon Agreement, 1979
- (D) NPT, 1968

Answer: (B) Outer Space Treaty, 1967

Q10. The International Space Station (ISS) was established in which year?

- (A) 1988
- (B) 1993
- (C) 1998
- (D) 2003

Answer: (C) 1998

Q11. 'Net Zero Portal' and 'NAPCC Dashboard' were launched by which ministry?

- (A) Ministry of Power
- (B) Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change
- (C) Ministry of New and Renewable Energy
- (D) NITI Aayog

Answer: (B) Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (launched by MoS Kirti Vardhan Singh)

Q12. World Ozone Day 2026 (16 September) focused primarily on which protocol, targeting HFCs?

- (A) Montreal Protocol
- (B) Kyoto Protocol
- (C) Kigali Protocol
- (D) Paris Agreement

Answer: (C) Kigali Protocol

Q13. India aims to become carbon neutral by which year?

- (A) 2050
- (B) 2060
- (C) 2070
- (D) 2080

Answer: (C) 2070

Q14. Poshan Abhiyaan's main objective focuses on brain development during the first how many years of a child's life?

- (A) 2 years
- (B) 3 years
- (C) 5 years
- (D) 7 years

Answer: (B) 3 years

Q15. The NAMASTE scheme is primarily meant for:

- (A) Street vendors
- (B) Manual scavengers/sanitation workers
- (C) Farmers
- (D) Fisherfolk

Answer: (B) Manual scavengers/sanitation workers

Q16. Hyderabad Liberation Day is observed every year on:

- (A) 15 August
- (B) 2 June
- (C) 17 September
- (D) 26 January

Answer: (C) 17 September

Q17. 'Operation Polo' (1948), through which Hyderabad was integrated into India, was led by:

- (A) Gen. K.M. Cariappa
- (B) Gen. J.N. Chaudhuri
- (C) Gen. Sam Manekshaw
- (D) Gen. K.S. Thimayya

Answer: (B) Gen. J.N. Chaudhuri

Q18. The Standstill Agreement between Hyderabad and India was signed on:

- (A) 15 August 1947
- (B) 29 November 1947
- (C) 17 September 1948
- (D) 26 January 1950

Answer: (B) 29 November 1947

Q19. Who was the last (7th) Nizam of Hyderabad?

- (A) Mir Osman Ali Khan
- (B) Salar Jung
- (C) Asaf Jah I
- (D) Mir Mahbub Ali Khan

Answer: (A) Mir Osman Ali Khan

Q20. Swachhata Hi Seva Campaign 2026 runs from 17 September 2026 to:

- (A) 2 October 2026
- (B) 17 October 2026
- (C) 31 October 2026
- (D) 14 November 2026

Answer: (B) 17 October 2026

Q21. Swachh Bharat Abhiyan was originally launched on 2 October 2014, dedicated to:

- (A) Jawaharlal Nehru
- (B) Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel
- (C) Mahatma Gandhi
- (D) B.R. Ambedkar

Answer: (C) Mahatma Gandhi

Q22. Djibouti recently became the ____ country to join NASA's Artemis Accords and the ____ African country to do so.

- (A) 70th; 7th
- (B) 71st; 8th
- (C) 72nd; 8th
- (D) 72nd; 9th

Answer: (C) 72nd country overall; 8th African country

Q23. India joined the Artemis Accords in which year?

- (A) 2020
- (B) 2021
- (C) 2022
- (D) 2023

Answer: (D) 2023

Q24. The Moon Agreement, dealing with prevention of pollution/littering on the Moon, was signed in:

- (A) 1967
- (B) 1979
- (C) 1998
- (D) 2020

Answer: (B) 1979

Q25. Michael Kremer, recently appointed Chief Economist of the World Bank, will replace:

- (A) Kristalina Georgieva
- (B) Indermit Gill
- (C) Ajay Banga
- (D) Gita Gopinath

Answer: (B) Indermit Gill

Q26. Michael Kremer won the Nobel Prize in Economics in 2019 jointly with Abhijit Banerjee and:

- (A) Esther Duflo
- (B) Amartya Sen
- (C) Elinor Ostrom
- (D) Paul Krugman

Answer: (A) Esther Duflo

Q27. Who was the first Indian to win the Nobel Prize in Economics, and in which year?

- (A) Amartya Sen, 1998
- (B) Abhijit Banerjee, 2019
- (C) Raghuram Rajan, 2015
- (D) Manmohan Singh, 1991

Answer: (A) Amartya Sen, 1998

Q28. The World Bank's original name at its formation in 1944 was:

- (A) International Monetary Fund
- (B) International Bank for Reconstruction and Development
- (C) International Development Association
- (D) International Finance Corporation

Answer: (B) International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD)

Q29. The 5th edition of the Women's Premier League (WPL) 2027 will be held from:

- (A) 1–20 January 2027
- (B) 14 January–7 February 2027
- (C) 1–28 February 2027
- (D) 14 February–10 March 2027

Answer: (B) 14 January – 7 February 2027

Q30. Which team has been the runner-up in every edition of the WPL held so far (2023–2026)?

- (A) Mumbai Indians
- (B) UP Warriorz
- (C) Delhi Capitals
- (D) Gujarat Giants

Answer: (C) Delhi (Capitals)

Q31. The 2029 World Athletics Championship — the first ever hosted by an African nation — will be held in:

- (A) Cairo, Egypt
- (B) Nairobi, Kenya
- (C) Lagos, Nigeria
- (D) Cape Town, South Africa

Answer: (B) Nairobi, Kenya

Q32. The headquarters of World Athletics is located in:

- (A) Zurich
- (B) Lausanne
- (C) Monaco
- (D) Geneva

Answer: (C) Monaco

Q33. Abhishek Sharma recently scored the fastest T20I century by an Indian, in just 30 balls, against which team?

- (A) Sri Lanka
- (B) Pakistan
- (C) Afghanistan
- (D) Bangladesh

Answer: (C) Afghanistan (at Arun Jaitley Stadium, Delhi)

Q34. Whose record for the fastest T20I century by an Indian did Abhishek Sharma break?

- (A) Virat Kohli
- (B) Rohit Sharma
- (C) Suryakumar Yadav
- (D) KL Rahul

Answer: (B) Rohit Sharma (35 balls vs Sri Lanka, 2017)